Am I a believer? A follower? Or a disciple?

Kuya Jec May 17, 2026

John 8:31-32
Luke 14:27

BELIEVER, FOLLOWER, DISCIPLE:

They have different meaning, depth, and commitment

BELIEVER

the one who trusts and nave faith

GREEK: *PISTEUO* meaning to believe, trust, be persuaded, to place confidence in; about faith and acceptance

When a Jew explains about faith, it means action. There is change, evidence.
The Greeks only agree in mind, but not in action.

John 3:16

During the Bible times, people find it difficult to believe the message without seeing miracles. Today, we only need the
Holy Spirit to seal the message in.our minds and lives

In the context of JOHN 3:16, a person accepts 3 things:

Who Jesus is
His message
His authority

James 2:19

To believe is a doorway. an entry point into the Kingdom of God.
Believing will also make a citizen progress inside the Kingdom of God.

FAITH (pananampalataya) and ***BELIEF*** (paniniwala)
are the same.
GREEK: mental acknowledgment
JEW: proof through change of mind and ways

Biblical faith is mental acknowledgment/ intellectual agreement
which should result in surrender and obedience.

FOLLOWER:

the one who walks behind another

GREEK: akoloutheo, meaning to follow someone, to accompany, to follow the same path, to join one's self to another (usually seen in students, soldiers, servants) •

The context of Matthew 4:19:

Jesus was not asking for admiration; He was calling people to leave the old direction and live the new life in Christ.

The context of Matthew 4:19:
Jesus was calling people to:

- Leave the old direction
- Walk with Him

- Imitate His lifestyle
- Submit to His "leadership"

In the Kingdom context, a follower is no longer living independently, because He follows the King constantly.

When a person decides to follow Christ,
he already agreed to the message and to apply the same message he believed in.

FOLLOWING involves obedience, movement, relationship, and daily surrender.
A person may believe, and yet resist following Him fully.

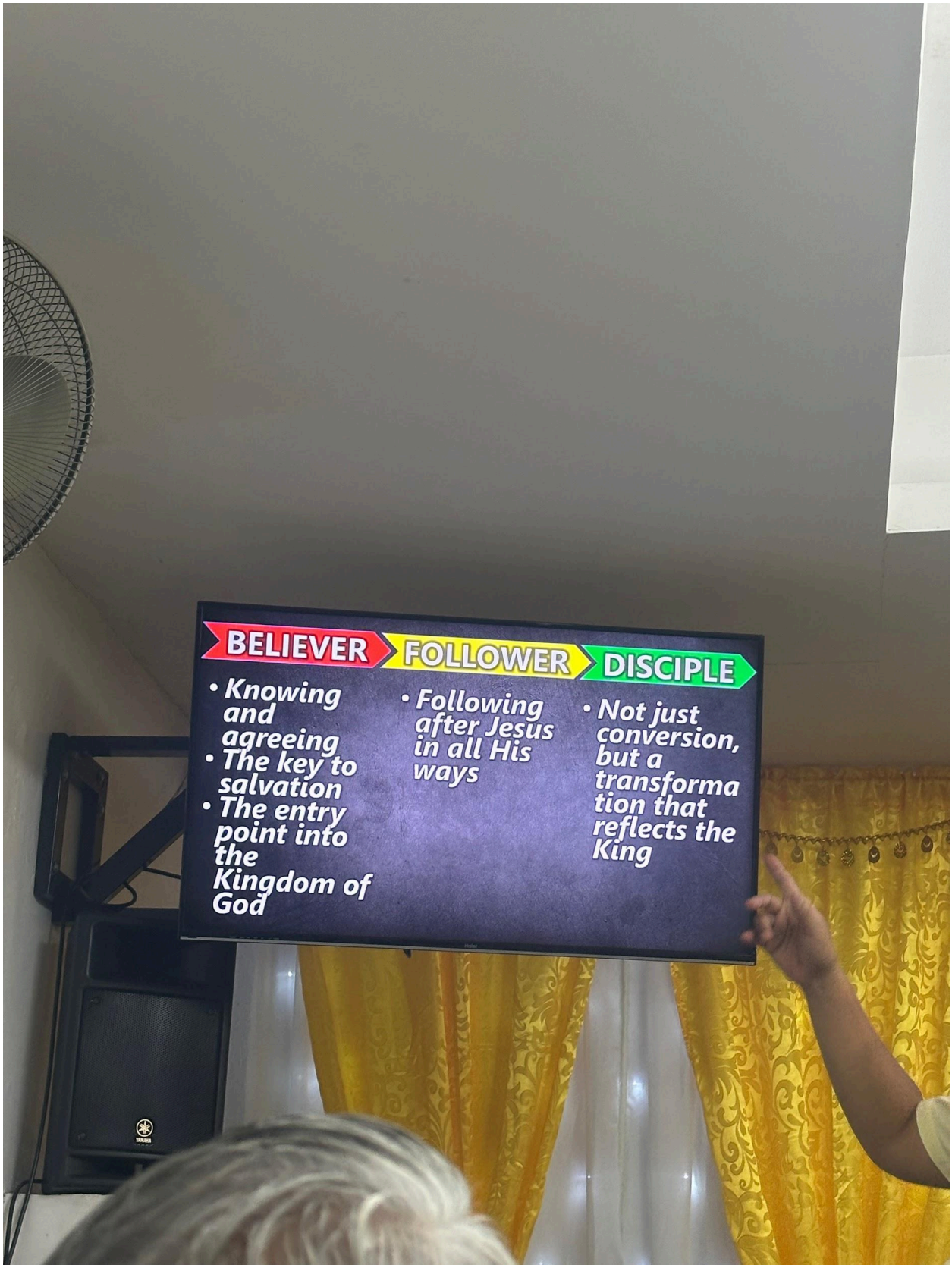
DISCIPLE:

A learner becoming like the Master
GREEK: ***mathetes***, meaning: Learner, student, apprentice and one who is being trained
The disciple lives with his master, learns his way of thinking and copies his teacher's lifestyle, and eventually, he will be presented by his master publicly.

DISCIPLE: deeper than casual belief because he learns his King's will and ways; he adapts the King's character; he obeys the King's commands, and reproduces the King's life in others

DISCIPLESHIP is not just information ; it is ***TRANSFORMATION***.

MATTHEW 13:58


BELIEVER
• Knowing and agreeing
• The key to salvation
• The entry point into the Kingdom of God
FOLLOWER
• Following after Jesus in all His ways
DISCIPLE
• Not just conversion, but a transformation that reflects the King